



English — Cbse English Language & Literature — 80 Marks

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The question paper has five sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D & E (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Sections D-E assess the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.
4. Marks for each question are indicated against it.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 2 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The River Remembers The river had no name that the new town remembered, yet it had outlived every boundary drawn upon its banks. It slipped through the valley like a ribbon of liquid glass, carrying in its current the sediment of forgotten monsoons and the ash of fires no living person could name. To stand at its edge at dusk was to hear a murmur that seemed older than language itself — a low, patient voice folding over stones. For generations, fishermen had cast their nets into its green shallows, and children had learned to swim in the pool beneath the old mango grove. The river held their footprints briefly, then smoothed them away, as though it kept its memories not in permanence but in the act of flowing. When the concrete bridge replaced the wooden one, when the rice fields gave way to brick houses, the river absorbed the change without protest, though its water grew quieter, as if grieving in a tongue no one stayed long enough to understand. Now, at the bend where the herons once gathered, a drain pipe weeps grey water into the current, and the kingfishers have thinned to ghosts. Yet on certain mornings, when mist lies across the surface like a held breath, the river seems to forget the town entirely. It remembers instead the forest that once pressed close to its edges, the deer that bent to drink, the silence before the first road was ever cut. It carries that older world forward, not as a wound but as a promise — that what flows does not vanish, but waits. (i) According to paragraph 1, what does the river carry in its current? [1 mark(s)] (A) The sediment of forgotten monsoons and the ash of unnamed fires (B) The footprints of children who swam in the mango grove (C) The grey water from the drain pipe at the bend (D) The nets of fishermen from the old town (ii) The river's water growing 'quieter' after the concrete bridge replaced the wooden one suggests that the river is — [1 mark(s)] (A) pleased by the arrival of modern construction (B) silently mourning changes it cannot prevent (C) becoming shallower due to reduced rainfall (D) losing its sense of direction through the valley (iii) The word 'permanence' in paragraph 2 most nearly means — [1 mark(s)] (A) a moment of great speed (B) a feeling of deep sorrow (C) a state of lasting forever (D) a sudden loud sound (iv) What literary device is used in the phrase 'the kingfishers have thinned to ghosts', and what does it convey? [1 mark(s)]	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(v) Why does the river seem to 'forget the town entirely' on misty mornings? [1 mark(s)] (vi) How does the passage present the river as both a witness to change and a keeper of memory? Support your answer with one detail from the text. [2 mark(s)]	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
2	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Quiet Magic of Small Habits We often imagine that success arrives in a single dramatic moment — a sudden breakthrough, a lucky break, an overnight transformation. The truth is far less glamorous. Real, lasting change usually begins in the most ordinary way: through a small habit repeated every day. A ten-minute walk, a page of reading, a few minutes of journaling — these acts seem almost trivial when viewed individually. Yet their cumulative effect can be remarkable. Consider the simple act of reading for fifteen minutes each day. In a single sitting, the gain is modest. Over a year, however, those minutes add up to dozens of books and a broadened worldview. The habit does not transform anyone instantly; it transforms them gradually, quietly, and permanently. This is the principle of compounding: small efforts, sustained over time, produce disproportionate results. Just as a tiny seed grows into a towering tree, a modest daily practice can reshape a person's character and capabilities. What makes habits so powerful is precisely what makes them easy to underestimate. They operate below the level of conscious attention. Once a behaviour becomes automatic, it no longer requires willpower or motivation. This is why habits are both a gift and a responsibility. Good habits carry us forward even on days when enthusiasm fades, while poor ones drag us down without our noticing. The student who reviews notes each evening does not need to "feel inspired" before studying; the habit does the work. Similarly, the person who reaches for a phone first thing every morning has already shaped the tone of their day — often without deciding to. Building a positive habit does not require grand resolutions. It requires consistency, patience, and a willingness to start small. The goal is not perfection but persistence. Missing a day is not failure; abandoning the effort altogether is. Habit formation is less about intensity and more about frequency. A short, regular practice will always outlast a sporadic burst of effort followed by burnout. Ultimately, habits are the quiet architects of our lives. They shape not only what we achieve but also who we become. Every repeated action casts a vote for a particular kind of future. When we choose habits that align with our values — discipline, curiosity, kindness — we are, in a sense, choosing the person we want to be. The power of a good habit lies not in any single act but in the steady accumulation of countless small ones, each one a quiet step toward a better self. (i) According to the passage, how does real, lasting change usually begin? [1 mark(s)] (A) Through a small habit repeated every day (B) Through a sudden stroke of good fortune (C) Through an intense period of concentrated effort (D) Through a dramatic overnight transformation	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(ii) Why does the author describe habits as 'both a gift and a responsibility'? [1 mark(s)] (A) Because they require financial investment to maintain over time (B) Because they are taught to us by others and we must pass them on (C) Because good habits help us progress while poor ones harm us without our awareness (D) Because habits are difficult to build but very easy to break (iii) Which of the following best captures the 'principle of compounding' as explained in the passage? [1 mark(s)] (A) Large efforts made occasionally produce better results than small daily ones (B) Only intense and continuous effort leads to meaningful personal growth (C) Habits become less effective the longer they are maintained (D) Small efforts sustained over time produce results that are surprisingly large (iv) The word 'sporadic' as used in the passage most nearly means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Regular and frequent (B) Continuous and steady (C) Occurring at irregular intervals (D) Intense and overwhelming (v) The word 'trivial' as used in the first paragraph means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Extremely dangerous (B) Of little importance (C) Highly beneficial (D) Impossible to measure (vi) According to the passage, what is more important than intensity in building a positive habit? [1 mark(s)] (vii) Why does the student who reviews notes each evening not need to 'feel inspired' before studying? [1 mark(s)] (viii) What is the central message of the passage about good habits? [1 mark(s)] (ix) How do habits act as 'the quiet architects of our lives'? Explain with reference to the passage. [2 mark(s)]	
Section B — Writing Attempt 2 out of 2.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	Informal Letter You are Aarav/Ananya, a Class 9 student living at 45, Rose Garden Road, Chandigarh. Your cousin Siddharth/Sneha, who lives in Delhi, has not visited your family for over a year. Write a letter to him/her inviting him/her to spend the summer holidays with your family. In your letter you may touch upon the following cues: • A family trip to Shimla planned for the first week of June • Your grandmother's 75th birthday celebration in mid-June • How long it has been since you last met and how much everyone misses him/her Word limit: 100-150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100-150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Formal Letter You are Aarav/Diya Singhal, a Class IX student of Modern Era Public School, Lake View Road, Bhopal. The school bus on Route 14 that serves your area has become highly unreliable — it is often late and sometimes does not arrive at all. Write a formal letter to The Regional Transport Officer, Madhya Pradesh State Transport Authority, Arera Hills, Bhopal, drawing attention to this problem and suggesting solutions. In your letter, cover the following points: • Introduce yourself and state the route you travel on daily. • Describe how the bus is frequently late or absent, causing students to miss assembly and classes. • Suggest displaying a fixed timing chart at each major stop. • Propose deploying a standby backup vehicle so students are not left stranded. Word limit: 100-150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100-150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i>	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	Story Writing Complete a story in 120–180 words using the opening line below. Give your story a suitable title. Opening line: <i>At the end of the dusty corridor in Grandma's old house, there was a door that was always locked.</i> <i>(Word limit: 120–180 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Informal Letter You are Vivaan/Vanya, a Class 9 student living at 18, Saffron Street, Pune. Your grandparents, who live in Nagpur, sent you a Kindle e-reader as a birthday gift. Write a letter to them thanking them for the gift and sharing some exciting news about a recent achievement at school. In your letter you may touch upon: • how much you love the gift and how you are using it • the exciting news you want to share (e.g., a competition result) • your plans to visit them during the holidays Word limit: 100–150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i>	5
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
5	The ___ guarded his territory fiercely, while the [Nouns (Naming Words)] (A) lioness (B) lion (C) tiger (D) tigress	1
6	If he were a better driver, he ___ the car last week. [Conditionals] (A) would not have crashed (B) would not crash (C) had not crashed (D) will not crash	1
7	The research team submitted their findings on time, ___ the review board approved them for immediate publication. [Conjunctions] (A) and (B) but (C) or (D) yet	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
8	The teacher suggested ____ the project in groups rather than individually. [Gap Filling] (A) to complete (B) complete (C) completing (D) completed	1
9	She has a keen interest in environmental science and sustainable development, ____ [Question Tags] (A) hasn't she (B) doesn't she (C) isn't she (D) didn't she	1
10	I will give you the money ____ you promise to return it on time without any delay. [Conjunctions] (A) as if (B) so as to (C) provided that (D) rather than	1
11	Each of the candidates ____ a resume along with a cover letter for the selection process. [Subject-Verb Concord] (A) submit (B) submits (C) are submitting (D) have submitted	1
12	Scientists ____ a new species of butterfly in the Western Ghats recently. [Tenses] (A) have discovered (B) discovered (C) are discovering (D) had discovered	1
13	The child talked as if he ____ a ghost. [Clauses] (A) had seen (B) sees (C) has seen (D) was seeing	1
14	____ and her sister won the first prize in the group song competition at the inter-school youth festival. [Pronouns] (A) Me (B) Herself (C) She (D) Hers	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section D — Literature (Short Answer) Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
15	How could the poet feel his mother's presence, even though she isn't there? <i>[Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]</i>	2
16	What is something that the elderly in your family cannot do easily but enjoy watching you do? <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	2
17	How does the present perfect tense effectively describe the transformation of the pankha handicraft over time? <i>[Ch 5: Winds of Change]</i>	2
18	What is the poet's purpose in using the word 'music' repetitively? <i>[Ch 12: A Friend Found in Music]</i>	2
19	Repetition — Why might the poet have begun and ended with the same line—'I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied vocations I hear!'? <i>[Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]</i>	2
20	Why do you think Khetaram has taken up this challenging job? <i>[Ch 13: Carrier of Words]</i>	2
21	What is the impact of the refrain, 'she's peerless, let's praise her!'? <i>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</i>	2
22	A canvas is similar to a garden plot as ____. <i>[Ch 6: Canvas of Soil]</i>	2
23	Would Sentila be able to fulfil her dream of becoming a pot maker? Explain. <i>[Ch 3: The Pot Maker]</i>	2
24	What might be Shruti's father's reaction? Why? <i>[Ch 11: Twin Melodies]</i>	2
Section E — Literature (Long Answer) Attempt all 4 questions. Each carries 5 mark(s).		
25	Contrast the vocations of pot making and weaving based on Arenla's perspective. Why did she believe weaving was a better option for Sentila, and how did this influence Sentila's initial approach to learning pottery? <i>[Ch 3: The Pot Maker]</i>	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
26	How does Subramania Bharati employ symbolism and allusion in the poem "Bharat Our Land" to celebrate India's spiritual and philosophical legacy? Explain with specific examples. <i>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</i>	5
27	Why does the narrator initially laugh at her grandmother's determination to learn at the age of sixty-two? <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	5
28	The line "The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity" carries a deep meaning about the relationship between one's work and one's self. Explain the significance of this line, discussing how different workers express their identity through their work. <i>[Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]</i>	5

